

Google introduces open source Gumbo HTML parser tool

Google is presenting developers with yet another open source tool—the Gumbo HTML parser, which is a C library of the HTML5 parsing algorithm. The company announced the open source code release in a post on the Google Open Source Blog by Jonathan Tang of the search features team.

“One of the big accomplishments of the HTML5 standard was to standardise the HTML-parsing algorithm, so that all browsers see the same HTML document in the same way,” wrote Tang. “So far, most implementations of this algorithm have either been tied to specific browsers or rendering engines, or they’ve been written in specific scripting languages. This makes it hard to write quick one-off tools to manipulate and clean up HTML if you don’t happen to be working in a language that already has an HTML5-compatible parsing library,” says the blog post.

Gumbo gives developers a simple library that can act as a fundamental building block for linters, refactoring tools, page analysis, templating languages, and other tiny programs that need to utilise HTML, writes Tang. The post further informs that the tool is written in pure C so that it can be easily interfaced with other languages, and bears no external dependencies. Since the beginning, Gumbo was constructed to support source locations and linking nodes in the parse tree with locations in the original text. You can find extra details about Gumbo and its usage, installation, etc., on the Gumbo project page.

7R4 is known for delivering the best performance with four sockets and 32 cores. According to IBM, the server is ideal for managing workloads that need analytics, factual computing and huge databases.

“Go ahead and copy our software,” says Red Hat CEO

After spending around US\$ 100 million on developing software, companies rarely let competitors clone and reproduce it. Companies like Apple, Samsung, LG,



Jim Whitehurst,
CEO, Red Hat

Windows and Google are investing a whole lot of energy and funds in fighting to protect their copyrights. However, according to Red Hat CEO, Jim Whitehurst, Red Hat is one company that actually encourages cloning.

In an interview, Whitehurst shares that although Red Hat certainly competes with Microsoft, typically, its IT decisions are not based on the Linux vs Windows war pattern. Now, the company’s decisions are heavily Linux-based. Whitehurst noted that Red Hat doesn’t worry about Microsoft in the long term, because it is now Red Hat and VMware that are defining the company’s future data centre strategy.

Whitehurst acknowledged that data centre software maker VMware is Red Hat’s No 1 competitor; he believes that no other company is able to match Red Hat’s ambitions as closely as VMware. But he adds, “When you start thinking about what the future of the data centre holds, VMware has a similar view to ours, but they’re doing it with a proprietary innovation model and we’re open.”

Microsoft unveils REEF Big Data framework

If Big Data is the next big thing in technology, one can expect Microsoft to come up with something that would cash in on the trend. The software giant recently unveiled a Big Data framework called REEF (a graciously simple acronym for Retainable Evaluator Execution Framework).

Sources in Microsoft said that the idea will be to open source the framework in about a month’s time. REEF has been designed in a manner that makes it run on top of YARN, the next-generation resource manager for Hadoop, and is particularly well suited for building machine learning jobs.

The information was unveiled by Ragu Ramakrishnan, Microsoft Technical Fellow and CTO of Information Services, who explained the concept in detail.

YARN, which has already been developed, runs as part of the Apache Hadoop project. This lets users run and manage multiple types of jobs (e.g., batch MapReduce, stream processing with Storm and/or a graph-processing package) atop the same cluster of physical machines.

Use of open source will accelerate in 2013: Survey

The open source movement is gaining momentum in 2013 among core groups, hints a survey conducted by electronics distributor Newark element14. The findings report that professional engineers, hobbyists and students are likely to use open source software and hardware for one or more design projects in 2013.

From those surveyed, 56 per cent of professional engineers will make use of BeagleBone and Arduino in 2013. However, among hobbyists, that figure is around 82 per cent, while for students it is around 85 per cent. In addition, 52 per cent of professional engineers will be using some open source software in 2013 (for hobbyists, it is 81 per cent and for students, 77 per cent).

Do these findings hold any significance for the engineering and design communities? They probably reveal how engineers’ views about open source are changing.